

improved 5s was not too large to be very significant, especially on contract. The 5s had a lot going for it – newer processors, better cameras and a fingerprint scanner on the home button supporting Touch ID. The 5s was the first smartphone ever to use a 64 bit processor which delivered up to twice the performance of its predecessor in CPU and Graphically intensive tasks. The fingerprint scanner also drew people in droves, with it being the first major ‘mainstream’ phone to feature one. Here’s a bit of trivia you might not know: the very first fingerprint scanners were on a couple of Toshiba phones way back in 2007, so there’s that.

The 5s was generally well praised and regarded as one of the best phones in the market when it launched.

6, 6s and SE

As usual, the next generation of iPhones promised more radical design changes. This time, there were two models of the iPhone released together – the iPhone 6 and the iPhone 6 Plus. They featured similar specs but differed in their screens and cameras. The 6 was a 4.7 inch screen with a resolution of 1334x750 and Apple’s iSight camera while the 6 Plus used a 5.5 inch screen with a 1920x1080 resolution and a much improved camera with a Sony EXMOR sensor. The bigger 6 Plus also had a much larger battery to go along with it. Both the phones featured an aluminium unibody design with the front pane of glass over the screen curving to meet it at the side, allowing for a nice, sleek, slab of metal+glass look. Apple sold 4 million units of these within 24 hours of pre-order availability, the most ever it has accomplished till date.

The 6s and the 6s Plus, which released a little less than a year later, featured the same externals but slightly bumped up internals. The chassis was strengthened (due to a design flaw in the 6 and 6s, some units underwent bending when kept in tight pant pockets – which was quickly nicknamed ‘bendgate’), the camera and processors improved and Apple’s newest feature, 3D Touch, was included. 3D Touch allowed people to apply varying amounts of pressure on the screen to get different results (more in Chapter 11 ahead). It also doubled the RAM from a single GB of the 6 and 6 Plus, to now have 2 GB in the 6s and 6s Plus.

The iPhone SE was also launched alongside the 6s and 6s Plus featuring pretty much the same exterior as the iPhone 5s but with most of the internals from the iPhone 6s. It was marketed as the budget option of iPhones and for those who’d prefer the smaller 4 inch screen size.